



CAMNEMI STUDY ADVISOR

JBNU · GKS-U

Why it is possible — and why it is so difficult

Jeonbuk National University
Global Korea Scholarship — Undergraduate (2026)



Part A — Why JBNU GKS-U is Possible

Eligibility summary

Evidence	Detail	Source
① JBNU is a Type B university	Listed among the 39 Type B universities in the Embassy Track	Guide p.4
② This program is GKS-U (Undergraduate)	For high-school graduates; bachelor's holders cannot apply → not GKS-G	Guide p.6–7
③ Business majors are available	Business Admin, Economics, International Trade, Accounting, Int'l Studies (TOPIK 3+)	University Info file
④ Cambodia is an invited country	Quota: General 2 + R-GKS 1 = 3 seats	Guide p.5
⑤ Applying without TOPIK is allowed	Language score submission is optional (FAQ)	Guide p.28–29

Bachelor's degree program is for applicants who graduated (or are expected to graduate) from a high school ... Applicants who have a bachelor's degree cannot apply.

However, being ABLE to apply is completely different from being ACCEPTED.

Part B — Why it is Difficult

Difficulty analysis

3 Only 3 seats Only 3 places are offered to Cambodia (2 General + 1 R-GKS). Hundreds apply — an ultra-competitive structure.	80% Grade bar Overall grades must be ① 80%+ on a 100-point scale or ② rank within top 20%. Converting Cambodian high-school marks is demanding.	25 Age limit Must be under 25 (born after 1 March 2001). Just one year over and you cannot apply at all.
--	---	--

Additional difficulty factors

Factor	Why it makes acceptance hard
① Competition ratio	Only 3 seats vs hundreds of applicants yearly — estimated acceptance 1% (no official ratio released)
② TOPIK bonus structure	TOPIK 3+ earns a 10% bonus on document screening. Without TOPIK you start at 0 bonus points
③ Documents & essays	With no language score, personal statement and study plan are decisive — they must be specific and persuasive
④ English & STEM preference	Strong English (TOEFL/IELTS) and science/engineering applicants are preferred in screening — business is not preferred
⑤ Korean training + TOPIK 3	Even after selection: 1 year of Korean training + reaching TOPIK 3 is mandatory to start the degree — a drop-out risk before enrollment



Factor	Why it makes acceptance hard
⑥ Single-application rule	Choose ONE track (Embassy or University) and ONE course (General or R-GKS) — a strategy mistake ends the year

Part C — Realistic Assessment

Consulting key points

Key message: You CAN apply (O). However, because of the 3-seat quota, the missing TOPIK bonus, and strict grade standards, ACCEPTANCE IS VERY DIFFICULT (△). Relying on GKS-U alone is risky — you MUST prepare a backup scholarship in parallel.

Recommended action	Detail
1. Verify eligibility	Check birthdate (under 25), high-school grades (80% / top 20%), and graduation (or expected) status first
2. Attempt TOPIK	Take TOPIK before applying — level 3+ gives a 10% bonus and makes degree entry easier
3. Focus on essays	Without TOPIK, write a specific personal statement and study plan on why JBNU business and your career plan
4. 3-school strategy	Embassy Track: JBNU (1st, Type B) + Korea University (2nd) + HUFS (3rd)
5. Backup is essential	Also prepare JBNU's own foreigner scholarship (IELTS 5.5 / TOPIK 2) and other universities' 80–100% admission scholarships
6. Check 2027 guide	2027 quota and schedule are announced by NIIED in mid-September — re-verify then

This document is based on the 2026 GKS-U Application Guidelines (NIIED) and the 'University Information' file. When the 2027 guideline is released, quota, schedule, and bonus criteria may change.